

HUM 101
Midterm Paper

General instructions -

- Minimum word limit is 1200 words. The upper word limit is 1500 words. These limits include your in-text citations and references.
- Maintain TURNITIN plagiarism under 10 percent.
- **You must write on only ONE out of the TWO essay questions.**
- Please use the shared reading materials as the primary resources (books and handouts for the class and shared on Google drive), and use scholarly secondary resources (academic publications, journal articles, scholarly materials. Use the resources available on Ayesha Abed Library).

- Total points for the essay are 20. The breakdown of the points is given below.

2 points for the meeting during class time on November 9 with the AI form and draft/outline before writing the essay;

2 points for the use of secondary resources;

2 points for the command of the course material;

4 points for the citations and references;

5 points for understanding the historical issues ;

5 points for student's position/opinion/analysis and academic clarity;

Submit your essay ONLY on TURNITIN before 11.59 PM, November 14.

Turnitin details to enrol in the class has been shared on the first page of the course outline. Any technical or internet related issues will not be considered, and the deadline won't be extended either. It's your responsibility to complete your work handily before time and not wait till the very last minute.

There is an AI form alongside this document that must be submitted in hard copy with your signature bearing your consent. This will be completed during the class time on November 9.

Essay Question 1

Construct an analytical essay tracing the **connections between myth and what they represented in ancient society, and their contributions behind the different functions of myths using specific mythical examples.**

Along with the primary sources, you will have to use a minimum of two **scholarly** secondary sources to illustrate your arguments. Please ensure that you cover the following points while constructing your essay:

- Establish a connection between ancient myths and how they were used to justify different ideas in society;
- Myth as a source of understating socio-political and cultural practices of ancient societies;
- A **critical analysis** on how religious narratives and/or philosophical discourses were shaped and conditioned through mythmaking;
- Myth as a testament towards appropriation of religious and political values.

Essay Question 2

Provide a comparative analysis of monarchical (Assyria, Persia and China) and non-monarchical (Ancient Athens and Rome) establishments of the ancient world in order to critically examine how administrative structures and political ideologies shaped and influenced law and governance of the ancient world.

In your critical examination/analysis you can incorporate the following factors for comparison:

1. Structures of governance- Compare administrative structures of either the Assyrian/Persian Empire with the structure of the constitution of ancient Roman Republic and see what the differences and commonalities are.
2. Control of power by the elites- If you compare any monarchies with the non-monarchies, do you see the elites having maximum power and control over wealth and resources? To what extent do you think the financially less well-off masses and women, had any power in both monarchy and non-monarchy in influencing the affairs of law and governance?
3. Political Ideologies as a force shaping governance- Compare between ideologies justifying monarchical establishment with Athenian *demokratia* or republic. Think of how justifications of monarchy (divine selection, powerful elite dynasties, need for geographical and political unification) and non-monarchy (ruled by the people, idea of freedom, equality and rule of law rather than empire) are creating justifications based on which different ideologies of governance were practiced in different civilizations of the ancient world

Good luck!